

C01 · KNOWING

The Stranger Across From Me

The Art of Really Knowing Someone

The Stranger Across From Me

For a few minutes you are a courteous stranger with a good ear, not a partner with a file.

1. In silence, about 5 minutes, each of you writes three questions a polite stranger could ask this person. Mix them: a memory of a year or room when they felt most like themselves; a habit a new friend would misread, and what that misreading gets wrong; a belief they rarely say in a group, asked so they can decline.
2. It qualifies only if it needs no shared history and cannot be answered in one word. Tear up anything worn out this month, and anything that is a flirt-test or a cross-examination.
3. Ask one at a time. One follow-up may ask to see the answer more clearly. It may not corner it. A declined question is a complete answer. Then swap.

Name one thing you had not known how to ask. Leave the rest on the paper.

Either of you may pass the whole card. Passing is a finished visit.